

Pronunciation 2 - Roman Letters for Japanese Vowels

A Quick Reference Guide

English Roman Alphabet Letters Used for Japanese Vowel Sounds 日本語の母音の音に英語のローマアルファベットの文字						
	日本語	Roman Letters, English ロマジ	Examples, e.g. 例えば	Official Transliteration or Romanization ローマ字	IPA 国際音声記号	Notes:
1	あ	o o, au, e, i, (i(gh)), y, u, a	(usually: 'o') h <u>o</u> p, <u>o</u> ncogene, st <u>o</u> p, b <u>o</u> p, m <u>o</u> p, <u>a</u> unt, <u>e</u> ye, quiet, h <u>i</u> nd, ~wh <u>i</u> te, by <u>e</u> , ~by <u>e</u> , bu <u>y</u> , <u>a</u> la-cart	あ= a,A	あ = ä , ɑ	The letters "a, i, e" alone are almost never used for the あ, い, え, sounds (respectively) in English. But these (sound-letter-uses) are common in European Romance Language: Spanish, French, Italian, etc.
2	い	ee, ea ee, ea, e, y, i, ie	(usually 'ee, ea') k <u>e</u> ep, t <u>e</u> a, b <u>e</u> at, P <u>e</u> te, city, f <u>i</u> eld,	い= i,I	い = ē,i,ə, i:	
3	う	oo oo, ou, u, ui, e	(usually 'oo') b <u>o</u> ot, s <u>o</u> up, l <u>u</u> te, fl <u>u</u> te, s <u>u</u> it, fl <u>e</u> w	う= u,U	う = u: , ō	
4	え	a a, e, ea, ae, ei, eigh, ey, ay, ai, au	(usually 'a') a <u>t</u> e, l <u>a</u> te, gr <u>e</u> at, A <u>e</u> sop, pr <u>e</u> y, pr <u>a</u> y, br <u>a</u> in, f <u>e</u> ign, <u>e</u> ight, g <u>a</u> uge,	え= e,E	え = ei , ā	<i>Note: English is not a "romance" language (not derived from Latin). See the language history section for more details.</i>
5	お	o o, oe, oa, e	(usually: 'o') h <u>o</u> pe, t <u>o</u> w, t <u>o</u> e, s <u>o</u> ap, s <u>e</u> w,	お= o,O	お = ō	The letter "o" often makes the お sound.
	A	B	C	D	E	F